I said I thought the students had no business being at the university if they weren't willing to abide by the rules; if they *refused* to obey them, they should go somewhere else.

Whenever I said that, the audience cheered. Californians just didn't like students tearing apart the university system of which they were so proud.

Once I got on the campaign trail, I discovered, a little to my surprise, that I enjoyed campaigning. And I was out to win.

I guess I'd been a competitive fellow since my childhood in Dixon and a political campaign was a competitive game of another sort, except the stakes were higher.

The question of how to deal with rebellious students became one of the central issues of the campaign, but it was just one of many problems troubling California in 1966. Californians paid the highest per capita taxes in the nation; the state's crime rate was the highest in the nation; it had the nation's most wasteful welfare program; it was threatened by increasing problems of air and water pollution. For more than a century, California had been a land of boundless opportunity attracting an ever-growing stream of immigrants from around the country and around the world. Its climate and easygoing lifestyle were part of the reason for its popularity, but perhaps more than other states, California symbolized opportunity: It was a place where people could make a new start—and with hard work, they could *make* it.

While newcomers were still flocking to California, the rate of migration to the state had begun to slow for the first time since the Gold Rush, largely because the pace at which it produced new jobs had begun to decline for the first time since the Depression. More and more businessmen were complaining of overregulation, high taxes, and an "adversarial" attitude toward them by state officials; they were giving up on California, electing to build new plants